

Care about and care for

Learner workbook

Say what matters to you and who you look after.

Understand the distinction

Care about commonly means consider important: I care about the environment. Care for can mean look after: She cares for her father. Take care of also means look after or deal with.

Care for can mean like or want in some contexts: I do not care for this music; Would you care for some tea? These uses are often more formal. I do not care can sound dismissive, so choose a clearer phrase when you simply have no preference.

Compare the patterns

IMPORTANCE

I care about the result.

The result matters to me.

LOOK AFTER

I care for my grandmother.

I help look after her.

NO PREFERENCE

Either time works for me.

A considerate alternative to I do not care.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. Complete: We care ___ clean water.

2. What does care for mean in He cares for his elderly neighbor?

3. Offer a polite alternative to I do not care when either restaurant is fine.

Use it in your own life

Write something important to you and a polite way to express no preference.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. about

This expresses importance or concern.

2. Look after.

The context describes providing care.

3. Either restaurant is fine with me.

This states a preference without sounding dismissive.

One possible response

I care about arriving on time. Either cafe works for me.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-33.html